Sample E (Test 3, Question 3 – Letter)

Dear Ann,

I was very glad when I got your letter this morning. I couldn't wait to answer it. You know I am really sad I won't be able to go with you this time, but don't be scarry, going there by yourself won't be any problem. We have always gone together, but it's time you fly alone!

Believe me, I don't think you will have any kind of problems. First, airport procedures are always the same, you first check-in, then go through Police control and then you look for your departure gate, that's it! We have done this hundreds of times. I have been told that these colleges are very well-organised and that you can book a room by internet, they have a good variety of places and you can choose from self-catering single rooms to shared rooms with families within the campus. So, take your time and start sending e-mails right now. I have also heard that they have very good social programmes, so meeting new people won't have to be difficult at all, my advice is that you should contact someone in the secetary to be informed of these as soon as you get there.

Don't forget that the rest of the students will be in a same situation, and these meetings will also provide the opportunity to speak their language with foreigners and locals as well.

Although the lessons won't be difficult I advice you to take advantage of the so-called 'preparatory language courses' which will be perfect to get used to listening teachers in their natural environment before the course starts.

This will be the right thing to do, enrolle the course in any of the colleges just choose the subject and go ahead.

Kisses

Scales	Mark	Commentary
Content	5	All content is relevant to the task and the target reader is fully informed. The reader would be able to follow the advice and make appropriate choices.
Communicative Achievement	5	The letter is written in an appropriate register and functional language is used effectively to offer suitable advice and to state opinions in a persuasive, supportive tone, fulfilling the communicative purpose of the letter. Both complex and straightforward ideas are clearly communicated to the reader, whose attention would be held.
Organisation	4	The letter is a well-organised, coherent whole, which makes good use of a variety of cohesive devices to link the ideas throughout the text. More complex organisational patterns, such as the comparison between the two friends' experiences are used to generally good effect.
Language	3	Everyday vocabulary is used appropriately and there is a range of grammatical forms used with a good degree of control. Errors tend to occur when more complex phrases/lexis or structures are attempted but this does not impede communication.